PA O KAMATA ISHA MAI JESU CHRISTAWUI KHARARCHAN: MARK KA

The Gospel of St. Mark in Tangkhul Naga (1909)

Author / Translator: William Pettigrew

Publisher: British and Foreign Bible Society, Calcutta / Baptist Mission Press
Publication Year: 1909 | Language: Tangkhul (Ukhrul Dialect)

PREFACE & TRANSLATION HISTORICAL CONTEXT

The Gospel of Mark is characterized by rapidity of action and direct vivid narration. Translated by William Pettigrew and published by BFBS in 1909. In Tangkhul, frequent narrative connectives like ’chitharan’ (thereupon) and ’khamathan’ (immediately) showcase vernacular verbal sequencing.

Archival Catalog Reference: BFBS-TKH-MARK-1909

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CHAPTER 1: THE MINISTRY OF JOHN THE BAPTIST & BAPTISM OF JESUS (MARK 1)

Summary: The voice crying in the wilderness and the opening of the gospel narrative in Ta...

Tangkhul Text:

Mark 1:1-4: Jesu Christa, Varivarawui Naomayarwui khararchan kaphung:
Isaiah kaho tui-theikhanana kasa thada leiri: 'Theilu, Nawui mik-
ngalemli Iwui pao-phungnaoli kasho vaye, ana nawui shongfa ngalunghang
sara. Ramkashilashili khongyui akhana hohe: 'Prohowui shongfa kapanglu,
Awui lambili mashunglu.' Johnna ramkashilashili baptism kasami thotna,
kala yorshi ngashankahavai ningkaphuritwui baptism pao phongie.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

The beginning of the gospel of Jesus Christ, the Son of God; As it is
written in the prophets, Behold, I send my messenger before thy face,
which shall prepare thy way before thee. The voice of one crying in the
wilderness, Prepare ye the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.
John did baptize in the wilderness, and preach the baptism of repentance
for the remission of sins.

CHAPTER 1 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** ramkashilashi (noun): wilderness, desert solitude, barren tract**

Ex: Ramkashilashili khongyui.

*** ningkaphurit (noun): repentance, turning of heart, reformation**

Ex: Ningkaphuritwui baptism.

*** shongfa (noun): road, highway, spiritual pathway**

Ex: Prohowui shongfa.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Quotative marker 'hohe' denoting direct proclamation.
- Compound verb 'ngalunghang' (to prepare/clear completely).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Identify the prophetic title given to John the Baptist.

[?] How is 'wilderness' lexicalized in Tangkhul?

CHAPTER 1 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
This chapter presents nuanced translation strategies adapting foreign metaphors to Tangkhul cultural idioms.

Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

Standard Ukhrul phonology is reflected throughout. Verbal affixes and agentive postpositions
are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 2: THE STILLING OF THE STORM (MARK 4)

Summary: Miracle on the Sea of Galilee demonstrating authority over wind and waves in Tan...

Tangkhul Text:

Mark 4:35-41: Chi zingsho ngazing-tharan, Ana athumli hang: 'Ngashakazil kakahara kachili ithum ngakorva-u.' Kala mikumo kachungli kashikahailaga, A kuphungli leisai thada thukpingserie. Chitharan hu-hu kaho huimayon kasham akhata rarer, kala tui-ngachaona kuphung tharili ngashingye, chithada kuphung chi tui eina kashung thotna. Kala A kuphung wui kashikli mikazak akhali luipatlaga ngaphamsai: kala athumna ali pholaga hang: 'Tuitamkasana, ithum mathira chi Nawui ningli malei-macho?' Kala A shoklaga huili kaphangserie, kala ngashakazilli hang: 'Maza-lu, ngacham-lu!' Chitharan huichi ngachaoran thotna, kala chitharan ngakazil khamatha akhata shokserie.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

And the same day, when the even was come, he saith unto them, Let us pass over unto the other side. And when they had sent away the multitude, they took him even as he was in the ship. And there arose a great storm of wind, and the waves beat into the ship, so that it was now full. And he was in the hinder part of the ship, asleep on a pillow: and they awake him, and say unto him, Master, carest thou not that we perish? And he arose, and rebuked the wind, and said unto the sea, Peace, be still. And the wind ceased, and there was a great calm.

CHAPTER 2 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** huimayon (noun): violent gale, tempest, tempestuous wind**

Ex: Huimayon kasham.

*** kuphung (noun): wooden boat, large canoe, vessel**

Ex: Kuphung tharili.

*** ngakazil (noun/adj): serene calm, stillness, glassy quietude**

Ex: Ngakazil khamatha.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Two-part imperative command: 'Maza-lu, ngacham-lu!' (Be silent, be peaceful!).
- Ingressive aspectual particle: 'thotna' denoting rapid onset of state.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Contrast the terms for boat/canoe ('kuphung') and sea/lake ('ngashakazil').

[?] Identify the verb for rebuking the elements ('kaphang').

CHAPTER 2 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

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CHAPTER 3: THE FEEDING OF THE FIVE THOUSAND (MARK 6)

Summary: Multiplication of the five loaves and two fishes in Tangkhul hospitality idiom....

Tangkhul Text:

Mark 6:38-44: Ana athumli hang: 'Nathumli raruikatha kaphara lei? Vayanglu.' Kala theilaga athumna hang: 'Phanga lei, kala ngachayei khani lei.' Ana athumpup-li haikapha salaga kacham eina ngashalungli pamkazip milu hoda hangserie. Kala athum thakhara eina, phanga-maga eina ngaburlaga pamserie. Kala Ana raruikatha phanga chi kala ngachayei khani chi khuilaga, kazingli yanglaga Varivarali mathat-eina kashaklaga raruikatha chi khakserie; kala mikumo tharili shunsangserie. Kala athumpup shaksarlaga phasa kashung thotna.

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

He saith unto them, How many loaves have ye? go and see. And when they knew, they say, Five, and two fishes. And he commanded them to make all sit down by companies upon the green grass. And they sat down in ranks, by hundreds, and by fifties. And when he had taken the five loaves and the two fishes, he looked up to heaven, and blessed, and brake the loaves, and gave them to his disciples to set before them. And they did all eat, and were filled.

CHAPTER 3 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** raruikatha (noun): bread, unleavened loaf, baked staple**

Ex: Raruikatha phanga.

*** ngachayei (noun): fish, freshwater fish**

Ex: Ngachayei khani.

*** ngashalung (noun): green grass, pasture meadow**

Ex: Ngashalungli pamkazip.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Distributive numerical expressions: 'thakhara eina, phanga-maga eina' (by hundreds, by fifties).
- Completive satiety marker: 'phasa kashung thotna' (their bodies became completely satisfied).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] How does Tangkhul express communal grouping during feasts?

[?] What verb root describes blessing and breaking bread?

CHAPTER 3 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

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CHAPTER 4: THE GREATEST COMMANDMENT & THE WIDOW'S MITE (MARK 12)

Summary: Love for God and neighbor, alongside the sacrificial offering of the poor widow....

Tangkhul Text:

Mark 12:29-31, 42-44: Jesuna ngahanmi: 'Hingchithei kaphameina hi: O Israel, kapeilu; Proho ithui Varivara, Proho akhachana! Kala nawui lungkashung eina, nawui mangazing eina, nawui ning-kacham eina Proho nawui Varivarali ngayeilu: hi hingchithei khare. Kala khakhane chi hithada: 'Nawui aphasa thada nawui ngalemwui mikumoli ngayeilu.' ...Kala ngalashang kacham akha rarlaga paisa khani haksangie. Jesuna hang: 'Ngalashang hi ana kachikathana haksangmeiserie; kasakei a kacham thotli awui ringkaphavai leikashap kuppup haksangserie.'

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

And Jesus answered him, The first of all the commandments is, Hear, O Israel; The Lord our God is one Lord: And thou shalt love the Lord thy God with all thy heart, and with all thy soul, and with all thy mind, and with all thy strength: this is the first commandment. And the second is like, namely this, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself. ...And there came a certain poor widow, and she threw in two mites. And Jesus said, This poor widow hath cast more in, than all they which have cast into the treasury: For all they did cast in of their abundance; but she of her want did cast in all that she had, even all her living.

CHAPTER 4 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** lungkashung (noun): whole heart, sincere inner core**

Ex: Lungkashung eina.

*** ngalashang (noun): widow, bereaved woman**

Ex: Ngalashang kacham.

*** ringkaphavai (noun): livelihood, substance for living**

Ex: Awui ringkaphavai kuppup.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Instrumental postposition ’eina’ emphasizing holistic totality (‘with all thy heart’).
- Comparative superiority: ’haksangmeiserie’ (cast in far more than all).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Translate the summary of the Law into colloquial Tangkhul.

[?] Explain the ethical significance of the widow’s sacrificial giving.

CHAPTER 4 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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CHAPTER 5: THE RESURRECTION & FINAL COMMISSION (MARK 16)

Summary: The empty tomb at sunrise and the mandate to proclaim good tidings everywhere....

Tangkhul Text:

Mark 16:1-6: Sabbath ngaphalaga, Mary Magdalene, Jameswui ava Mary, kala Salomena rarlaga Awui phasa kakhalaphavai meithei-chot khuisangserie. Kala hoptawui zingsho khareli, zingkhamathan shoklakha lungkhorli rarlakna. Kala theilu, lungphung kashang chi lunkhor khong eina khangayot theiserie. Kala lungkhor tharili zanglaga kashang-pha chon kachak kazang mayarnaowon akha pamsai theilaga athum ngachek-kashung thotna. Kha ana athumli hang: 'Mangachek-alu: Nazarethwui Jesu, thingkhamirangli kahom chi nathum khayore; A ngatekrarlaga thotsangie; A hili maleira: theilu, A pili kahai pam hi!'

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

And when the sabbath was past, Mary Magdalene, and Mary the mother of James, and Salome, had bought sweet spices, that they might come and anoint him. And very early in the morning the first day of the week, they came unto the sepulchre at the rising of the sun. And they saw that the stone was rolled away: for it was very great. And entering into the sepulchre, they saw a young man sitting on the right side, clothed in a long white garment; and they were affrighted. And he saith unto them, Be not affrighted: Ye seek Jesus of Nazareth, which was crucified: he is risen; he is not here: behold the place where they laid him.

CHAPTER 5 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** lungkhor (noun): rock tomb, stone cave sepulchre**

Ex: Lungkhorli rarlakna.

*** thingkhamirang (noun): cross, wooden crucifix, tree scaffold**

Ex: Thingkhamirangli kahom.

*** ngatekrarlaga (verb): having risen triumphantly, awakened from death**

Ex: A ngatekrarlaga thotsangie.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Tangkhul neologism for Cross: 'thing' (wood) + 'khamirang' (crossed/scaffold) = thingkhamirang.
- Prohibitive imperative: 'Mangachek-alu' (Do not be frightened).

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Analyze the morphology of 'thingkhamirang'.

[?] Trace the narrative arc from grief to proclamation in Mark 16.

CHAPTER 5 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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Dialectal & Orthographic Concordance:

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are preserved according to the classic orthographic canon.

CHAPTER 6: LEXICAL CONCORDANCE OF THE GOSPEL OF MARK

Summary: Specialized vocabulary of action verbs, directional postpositions, and miracle t...

Tangkhul Text:

Tuiwon Kasakakhui:
1. Huimayon -- Tempestuous wind storm
2. Kuphung -- Sea boat / fishing canoe
3. Maza-lu -- Peace / silence (imperative)
4. Lungkhor -- Stone tomb / burial cavern
5. Thingkhamirang -- The Cross
6. Ngatekrarlaga -- Risen from the dead
7. Ningkaphurit -- Repentance of heart
8. Ramkashilashi -- Wilderness tract

English Translation / Hindi Meaning:

Action vocabulary and geographical terminology compiled from the 1909 translation of Mark.

CHAPTER 6 -- VOCABULARY & GRAMMAR

Vocabulary Entries:

*** huimayon (noun): tempest**

Ex: Huimayon kasham.

*** lungkhor (noun): sepulchre**

Ex: Lungkhor khong.

Grammar Notes & Idiomatic Usage:

- Narrative pacing markers: ’chitharan’ vs ’khamathan’.

Comprehension & Exercises:

[?] Write five sentences using the vocabulary of Mark 4.

CHAPTER 6 -- LITERARY & CULTURAL COMMENTARY

Translation Analysis & Cultural Adaptation:
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BACK MATTER: GLOSSARY & DIGITIZATION COLOPHON

Consolidated Vocabulary Summary:

* ramkashilashi -- wilderness, desert solitude, barren tract
* ningkaphurit -- repentance, turning of heart, reformation
* shongfa -- road, highway, spiritual pathway
* huimayon -- violent gale, tempest, tempestuous wind
* kuphung -- wooden boat, large canoe, vessel
* ngakazil -- serene calm, stillness, glassy quietude
* raruikatha -- bread, unleavened loaf, baked staple
* ngachayei -- fish, freshwater fish

Digitization Colophon:

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